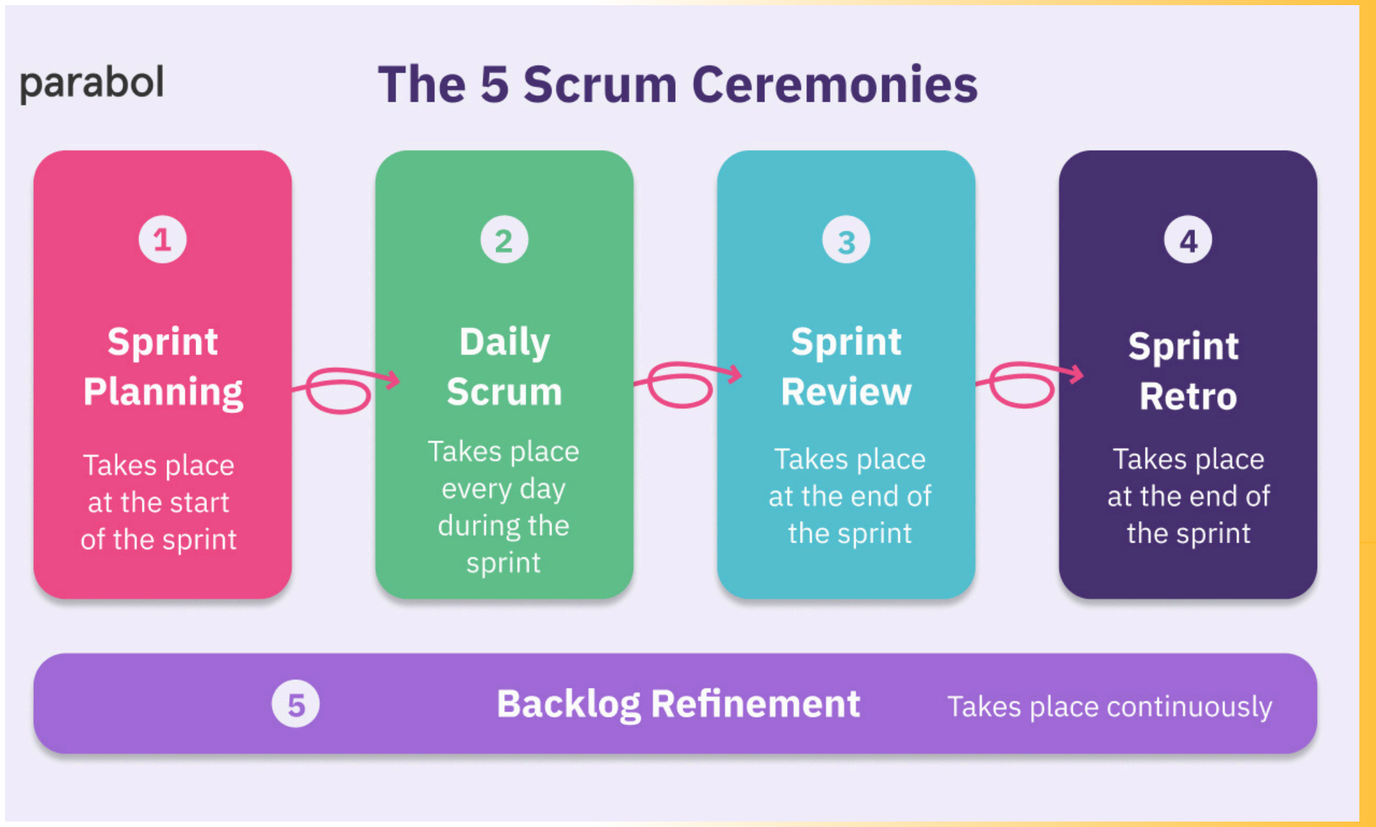
Scrum ceremonies



file:///Users/daongochuyen/Documents/Teaching/E4IT/Materials/20_questions_game_html.html



English for IT Professionals - Lesson 7

Attend a retrospective meeting

April 2026

Learning Objectives

- Identify and use key vocabulary for retrospective meetings
- Practice useful phrases for sharing feedback and suggesting improvements
- Participate confidently in a retrospective discussion
- Understand the purpose and structure of retrospective meetings in Agile development

Lead-in

Discuss

- **When do we have a retrospective meeting?**
- **What is the purpose of a retrospective meeting?**
- **What do you usually share in a retrospective?**



A retrospective meeting is held at the end of each sprint. The team, including developers, QA, and BA, meets to reflect on their work.

During the meeting, participants take turns to share what went well, what challenges they faced, and what improvements can be made. They also share their input on the process and teamwork.

Team members may point out key problems and propose solutions.

Based on the discussion, the team aligns on a few action items to improve the next sprint.

1. point out (v) mention something important clearly
2. propose (v) recommend a plan or idea
3. reflect (v) think about the past
4. action item (n) a task to do after the meeting
5. align (v) reach a decision together
6. challenge (n) difficulty that affects progress
7. improvement (n) a way to make something better
8. input (n) comments to improve something
9. take turns (phrasal verb) discuss one by one

Match the highlighted words to their definitions

A retrospective meeting is held at the end of each sprint. The team, including developers, QA, and BA, meets to reflect on their work.
During the meeting, participants take turns to share what went well, what challenges they faced, and what improvements can be made. They also share their input on the process and teamwork.
Team members may point out key problems and propose solutions.
Based on the discussion, the team aligns on a few action items to improve the next sprint.

Fill-in-the-blank 1-9

align - input - take turns - improvement - challenge - reflect - point out - propose - action item

Pick a new vocab word and put it to the right sentence

1. Let's __reflect__ and see what we did well this sprint.
2. I'd like to __point out__ a problem with the deployment process.
3. One major __challenge__ was the delay in API response.
4. I'd like to __propose__ a better testing approach.
5. This is an important __improvement__ for the next sprint.
6. Let's create an __action item__ to fix this problem.
7. During the meeting, we usually __take turns__ to share ideas.
8. Thanks for your __input__ on this issue.
9. Let's __align__ on the next steps before ending the meeting.

Language Focus: Useful Sentences

What went well was …

Intent: Share positive feedback
Example: What went well was the team collaboration.
Alternative: One thing that went well was the team collaboration.

One challenge we faced was …

Intent: Talk about problems
Example: One challenge we faced was unclear requirements.
Alternative: One problem we had was unclear requirements.

I’d like to point out that …

Intent: Emphasize something important
Example: I’d like to point out that testing took longer than expected.
Alternative: I want to point out that testing took longer than expected.

Language Focus: Useful Sentences

I’d like to propose that we …

Intent: Suggest improvements
Example: I’d like to propose that we improve communication with the backend team.
Alternative: I think we should improve communication with the backend team.

We could improve by …

I***ntent:*** Propose improvement
Example: We could improve by adding more unit tests.
Alternative: Maybe we can improve by adding more unit tests.

Let’s align on …

Intent: Decide action items
Example: Let’s align on the key action items for the next sprint.
Alternative: Let’s agree on the key action items for the next sprint.

Fill-in-a-blank I-6

one challenge we faced
could also improve
what went well
I’d like to propose
Let’s align on
I’d like to point out

BA: “Alright team, let’s start our retrospective. Let’s take turns to share.”
Dev: “Sure. (1)_What went well_ was the frontend delivery. Everything was on time.”
QA: “I agree. The user input was also very positive.”
BA: “Great. Now, (2)_one challenge we faced_ was the delay from the API.”
Dev: “Yes, (3)___I’d like to point out___ that the backend response was slow.”
QA: “That created a testing challenge as well.”
BA: “Thanks. Do you have any ideas for improvement?”
Dev: (4)_I’d like to propose_ that we improve communication with the backend team.”
QA: “We (5)_could also improve_ by adding mock APIs earlier.”
BA: “Good point. Let’s reflect on this and decide next steps.”
BA: “(6)___Let’s align on___ some action items.”
BA: “First, improve API communication. Second, prepare mock data earlier.”
BA: “Who can take this action item?”
Dev: “I can take the API communication task.”
QA: “I’ll take the mock data setup.”
BA: “Perfect. Thanks everyone!”

Common expressions used in daily standup

Start → Positive → Issue → Improvement → Align → Assign

Arrange the expressions in the suggested order to form a logical retrospective meeting dialogue.

4-6-2-3-1-5

1. Let’s align on the action items for the next sprint.
2. One challenge we faced was the delay in API response.
3. I’d like to propose that we improve communication with the backend team.
4. Alright team, let’s start our retrospective and take turns to share.
5. Who can take this action item?
6. What went well was the team collaboration.



Role-play

Scenario: Retrospective Meeting

Let’s role-play a **retrospective meeting** scenario. One person will take the role of the **SM**, and the others can choose to be **developers** or any other roles in the product team.

SM

- Start and guide the meeting
- Ask team members to share
- Summarize and assign action items

Other team members

- Share what went well
- Share issues
- Suggest improvements

Discussion Questions

Pick a question to discuss

1. What usually goes well in your sprint?
2. What common issues does your team face?
3. How do you decide action items?

Homework



RECORD YOUR TALK

Record yourself talking about a summary of a recent sprint you experienced. Make sure to cover what went well, what could have been better, any suggestions from the team to improve and the results of applying those suggestions if any. Share your recording in the Zalo group to receive detailed feedback.